

JAMES CATHERINE HARRISON

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior engineer with a decade of hands-on experience building and maintaining distributed systems at scale. I've led infrastructure modernization efforts that reduced deployment times by 60 percent and mentored junior engineers through complex architectural decisions. My background spans cloud architecture, Kubernetes orchestration, and DevOps practices. I enjoy solving gnarly performance problems and translating technical constraints into pragmatic solutions that business teams can understand.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Principal Engineer

CloudScale Systems

cloudscale.io

Liverpool, United Kingdom

March 2022 - Present

Designed and implemented a multi-region Kubernetes infrastructure supporting 200+ microservices with 99.99 percent uptime across three availability zones.

Led a team of five engineers through a complete migration from monolithic services to event-driven architecture, reducing operational overhead by 45 percent.

Established infrastructure-as-code standards using Terraform and Helm, enforcing consistency across 40 production environments and cutting provisioning time from two weeks to one day.

Mentored six junior engineers in production debugging, cloud security practices, and distributed systems design patterns through structured pair programming and design reviews.

Senior DevOps Engineer

NetworQ Limited

networq.co.uk

Manchester, United Kingdom

June 2019 - February 2022

Architected a comprehensive CI/CD pipeline using GitLab and Jenkins that reduced release cycles from monthly to multiple daily deployments for ten product teams.

Implemented comprehensive monitoring and alerting using Prometheus and Grafana, achieving 95 percent faster incident detection and reducing mean time to recovery from 90 minutes to 15 minutes.

Managed AWS infrastructure for 150 microservices including RDS, ElastiCache, and S3, optimizing costs by 35 percent through reserved instances and storage lifecycle policies.

Designed and delivered internal training program on Kubernetes and cloud best practices that upskilled 25 team members and reduced external consulting costs by 200,000 pounds annually.

Infrastructure Engineer

DataFlow Technologies

dataflow.io

Liverpool, United Kingdom

August 2014 - May 2019

Built and maintained on-premise data center infrastructure supporting 500 virtual machines across ESXi clusters, managing 40TB of storage using NetApp systems.

Automated infrastructure provisioning and configuration management using Ansible and Puppet, reducing manual server setup time from eight hours to twelve minutes per instance.

Implemented disaster recovery and backup strategies using Veeam and rsync that achieved recovery time objective of two hours and recovery point objective of one hour.

Supported migration of legacy applications to AWS, planning network architecture and security groups for twelve critical systems with zero downtime cutover.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Manchester

Manchester, United Kingdom

Graduated 2014

SKILLS

Cloud Platforms: AWS, Azure, Google Cloud Platform

Container Orchestration: Kubernetes, Docker, Docker Swarm

Infrastructure as Code: Terraform, CloudFormation, Ansible, Puppet, Helm

CI/CD Tools: GitLab CI, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, ArgoCD

Monitoring and Observability: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, Datadog, New Relic

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, DynamoDB

Scripting Languages: Python, Bash, Go

Networking: TCP/IP, DNS, VPN, load balancing, security groups

Version Control: Git, GitLab, GitHub

Security: SSL/TLS, IAM, network security, vulnerability scanning